Several Trojan Skirmishes and One Wooden Animal

The Story of the Greatest War on Earth

By Clyde Hendrickson

A long, long time ago, in a land far, far away, the great gods of Olympus were attending the wedding of King Lysol and the sea nymph Tide. Unfortunately, the deities had *forgotten* to invite the goddess of discord, Eris. She was enraged - the gods saw her as unimportant and troublesome, and she knew she would be missing a delightful salad bar at the feast. So, she decided to cause discord, because, after all, that was her job.

In the middle of the proceedings, Eris heaved a golden apple through the window marked "To The Most Stupid." Of course, none of the gods wanted this title, and they all fought amongst themselves to decide which would not get the apple. Zeus, who was lazy and had other fish to fry, decided that simple-minded Paris would do the honors of judging the immortal gods.

Each god, to try to win his favor, decided to bribe Paris. The competition came down to two women, Hera and Aphrodite. Hera, knowing that she was not too bright, approached Paris first.

She said, "Paris, if you give the apple to Aphrodite, I will let you conquer all of Europe, Asia, and maybe even New Jersey."

To this, simple-minded Paris said, " Uhh... Duhh.... Ummm... What?"

Aphrodite was next. She was just a tad smarter than Hera, and knew what Paris really wanted.

"If you give the apple to Hera, I will give you the most beautiful woman in the world," The goddess of love told him.

Paris replied, "Um, all right. I don't like New Jersey, anyway."

The judgment had been made. Hera was the stupidest of the Olympians and received the golden apple. She vowed to make Paris pay, but he paid little attention as he was led away by Aphrodite. Little did the simpleton know that Hades has no fury like a goddess's scorn.

The most beautiful woman in the world was no doubt Helen. Unfortunately, she had been dead for 400 years, and her mummified body was a tourist attraction at the house of Manyscars in Sparta. Aphrodite gave Paris the power to raise her from the dead, and she returned with him to his home state of Troy.

Manyscars, furious that his prized cashcow had been stolen from him by an Asia Minor hillbilly, united all of Greece against Troy. With Hera and Athena at his side, he was ready to lay siege to the wondrous city across the sea. However, two men were missing from his party. They were King Ondajon of the island of Ithaca, and the invulnerable, very vain warrior, Tendinitis.

The king of Sparta first sent his messenger to the land of King Ondajon. When the messenger arrived, the ruler was nowhere to be found, so he called out in the castle hall,

"King Ondajon! I'm looking for the great King Ondajon!"

A servant quickly responded, "Sir, I am afraid you are mistaking. There is no king using our restroom facilities, or 'on the john' as you put it."

"No, no, I'm looking for the king named Ondajon."

"Oh. He's out back, having a martini."

The messenger quickly made his way to the rear porch of the castle. There, he saw the king sipping his cocktail and mumbling about something.

"Sir, I am from glorious King Manyscars's battle fleet. We would like your help in defeating the pesky Trojans," the messenger announced.

"Guinea Pigs," the King said.

"Excuse me?"

"Guinea pigs."

"Yes, yes, guinea pigs. Good King Ondajon, will you accompany me to the fleet?"

"Are there guinea pigs there?"

"Uhh... " the messenger had to think quickly, "...yes. Thousands of guinea pigs. As far as the eye can see."

"Who's eye? Because, if it's a blind man's eye, he can't see any guinea pigs."

"No, no, sir, a young man's keen eye."

"Excellent. I will summon my troops there tomorrow."

Meanwhile, the skilled warrior Acracked was dispatched to find Tendinitis, the very vain warrior. He found him in full dress at a quilting bee.

"Good day, Tendinitis. I am your fellow Greek warrior, Acracked. I am here to bring you with me on a quest."

Tendinitis responded in high, squeaky voice.

"I am on a quest - a quest for the perfect shoes to match this outfit."

"Well sir, we are going to Troy, and I hear they have lovely shoes there."

"Ah, yes! Well, I will have to join you!"

"Excellent! May I ask what you are weaving on your quilt?"

"A decapitation scene. Oh, I do love violence."

"Then you'll fit right in with our group. Let's go." And they went.

Meanwhile in Olympus

In the great palace atop Mount Olympus, two great gods, Poseidon and Hermes, were watching the earth. Specifically, they were watching a man whose hat Poseidon kept blowing off his head. Both deities were getting quite a kick out of this when Zeus stormed in, bellowing,

"Enough with that! It's time for some real fun!"

"Oo! oo! what do we get to do, huh, huh?" they squealed in unison.

"We're gonna go watch the humans kill each other!"

"Goody goody gumdrops!" yelled Poseidon.

*** *** ***

So, the Greeks headed out. For the next nine years, both sides slaughtered countless men, the ground was soaked with blood, but nothing very exciting actually happened. Then, early in the tenth year of the war, Tendinitis got into a fight with another of the great chieftains, Aggravation. It seems they were fighting over which was leader in killing statistics. Tendinitis was the first to speak out at a meeting of the Greek council.

"My dear comrades, I am afraid you have made a grave mistake. The kill board says that I am second in people slaughtered with 6091, to Aggravation's 6092. Surely, there has been some error."

Aggravation quickly replied, "Nonsense! I have killed more men than you, and don't call me Shirley."

"You have beefed up your statistics, my friend. I know for a fact that the last two men you defeated you backed over with your chariot."

"Uhh... yes, that is true, but I'm sure I wouldn't have hit them if the gods had not willed them dead by my hand. Ask the good chieftain Ondajon, he will agree with me."

"What? Why would I ask the person who was on the toilet?"

"No, no, no. The chieftain named Ondajon."

"You should make yourself more clear, Aggravation. Ondajon, have you any say in this matter?"

Now the great ruler of Ithaca rose from his seat, and cleared his throat for what appeared to be a rousing speech. He glanced around the room, and then spoke these words:

"Yes. However, I had quite a traumatic experience today involving a terribly impolite dog named Cerebus and three of my guinea pigs, so I'm not in the mood to talk. Please, carry on."

This threw the meeting into disorder, not because the words had a profound impact, but because no one had any idea what they meant. Aggravation went out back to have a smoke while Tendinitis went to his tent, vowing to stay there in his woman's clothes until he regained his honor.

*** Meanwhile in Olympus ***

"Hey hey hey out there in classic literature land, I'm Zeus, and boy, you look like a great crowd. Any of you out there form Jersey? Really, what exit? Ha Ha! Budda-bing, Budda-boom, eh folks? Let's get on with the show. You know, I had the oddest thing happen to me today - I had to shoot a hydra in my underpants. What he was doing in my underpants, I'll never know. Then this girl comes up to me, and asks, 'how do you gods sleep, with all the bad stuff going on in the world?' You know what I said?"

"What?"

"I said, 'we sleep with our eyes closed!' Get it? With our eyes closed! Budoomboom. Well, kids, that's all for today. See you next time, ladies and germs. Goodnight!"

*** *** ***

A few days after the big fight, Greece was in deep dog doodoo. Troy, led by their great fighter Heckuva, was kicking booty in every battle, even beating the Greeks back to their ships. However, one of the Trojan warriors made a grave mistake. While on a mad killing rampage, he murdered Ondajon's prized guinea pig, brutally beat Tendinitis's best friend, and even short sheeted Aggravation's bed. Now, these three were united again, and together they would bring down Troy.

When dawn approached, sour and smelly fingered, the entire Greek force of over 400,000 men launched an all out assault on Troy. Up on the city walls, Paris watched in dismay as thousands of his friends were slaughtered. He quickly ran to warn his father, King Priam.

"Great King Priam! The great man Ondajon approaches with Tendinitis on his rear and Aggravation by his side. Oh, Heckuva the warrior could not even fell these

determined men," Paris screamed as he entered King Priam's chamber. The king gave Paris an annoyed look and said,

"Paris, what do I care of the man who is on the jon? I certainly do no want to know that he has tendinitis in his rear, and if his side is so aggravated, tell him to take an Aspirin. And why in the world would we need a heck of a warrior to defeat him? Go away."

Paris, looking gloomy, returned to the lookout post, knowing their fate was sealed.

Meanwhile, Tendinitis had met Heckuva outside the walls of Troy. The gods of Olympus were wagering money on the fight, and were trying to help their man. Athena came to the assistance of Tendinitis. Heckuva, unfortunately, had the help of Silenus, who was a drunk, fat, and unimportant god. He knew he was about to get his butt whipped, so Heckuva ran around the city three times, clicked his heels and yelled something about there being no place like home, but this was unsuccessful.

Tendinitis struck first. His spear, however, hit a women who was standing in the middle of the battlefield. She was later identified, and had a very strange name: Edith Hamilton. Anyway, Heckuva took advantage of the situation and attacked with his sword. He could not penetrate Tendinitis's armor, because it was made of Kevlar, a substance made by the blacksmith of Olympus, Dupontus. Tendinitis killed Heckuva, and did a little touchdown dance to celebrate. He even spiked Heckuva's head in the endzone.

The gods were enraged by the great and pretty warrior's boastfulness. They then had their revenge. They filled Paris with courage, who ran out onto the battleground and gave Tendinitis a dead leg. Tendinitis was in so much pain that he limped around until he hopped right off a cliff and fell 500 feet to a watery grave. Simple-minded Paris, having lost his godlike boldness, was chopped into itty-bitty pieces and also heaved off the cliff.

So, the Greeks and Trojans were pretty much even again. The war looked like it was going to last another ten years until one night, while staring at a oak-colored guinea pig, the mentally unstable King Ondajon had a brilliant idea. He shared it with the others at the Assembly:

"My comrades," he began, "Last night, I had what was quite frankly a brilliant idea. It will lead to the fall of Troy and to our glorious victory." At this, the crowd cheered. The king continued,

"Here is my plan. We will construct a giant wooden guinea pig, hollow so that many of the real animals can fit inside. We will then surrender to the Trojans, and offer them the enormous monument as a sacrifice. They will wheel it into the city, and on that night, the guinea pigs will leap out and destroy the entire population with their fiery breath and razor sharp teeth."

The group of men were so joyful when they heard this wonderful contrivance that they ran wildly around the room, screaming and smashing things. One of them yelled "mosh pit!" loudly, and the entire company started slamming into each other to the rocking tunes of the Rolling Stones, who were just getting started then.

Within five days, the contraption was quickly prepared. The day after the Greeks surrendered, everything was ready when dawn appeared, sour and smelly fingered. However, just as the men were wheeling the great wooden guinea pig up to Troy, they realized they had done something wrong. They had forgotten to give the guinea pigs a way of getting out of their vehicle.

So, the unlucky soldier Gonnadi was elected to ride the enormous mount into the city. When he asked what his excuse should be, the chieftains just said to make up any old story.

It took three days for Gonnadi to convince the Trojans to take in the guinea pig, and he changed his story fifteen times. Finally, he fooled them into thinking he was Zeus by performing several cheesy card tricks which the Trojans had never seen before. That night, when Gonnadi was alone with the giant fabricated creature, he released the guinea pigs. Perhaps the mayhem which ensued is best described by Hickus Maximus, a Trojan warrior:

"Duhhh... Well, them guinea things, they come a runnin' over the hills, burning everything they got their little feet on. They even killed my wife, which made me real sad, cause she was my lil sister too."

When dawn came, sour and smelly fingered, Troy was flattened. The Greeks had won a great victory. To thank the guinea pigs for winning a war which ten years of human toiling could not, they sacrificed them and some wine to the great god Zeus. However, the Greeks made a horrendous mistake. They made the sacrifice with a number 240 white zinfandel, when everyone knows that the god of thunder prefers a number 241 white zinfandel. For this sacrilege, most of the Greeks were killed on their return voyages.

*** Meanwhile in Olympus ***

"Brother Poseidon, what do you have to say in the matter?" Zeus asked

"Lord Zeus, I believe the metric system is far more convenient than the standard one."

Another voice piped up. "I, Hermes, will not rest until the metric system is shown as the offensive garbage it is."

"But Hermes, as king of the gods, I can see that you are better at numbers than we are. After all, you are the god of commerce, aren't you? You're just trying to keep us out of your little ring."

"No, Zeus, I would never do that. Besides, how could I be better at numbers? Were all immortal gods with incredible powers."

"Oh yeah, I always forget that. You know, I think I forgot to mark that down on the last census."

*** *** ***

And so, the greatest war on earth was over. Troy was in ruins, with its citizens sold into slavery, and the Greeks had been killed by the gods. In fact, just about everyone was dead or dying, and Ondajon had retired to Bermuda with about two million guinea pigs. Well, there is one happy thing about this ending - Since everyone is dead, it leaves no room for a Trojan War II.

The End

Make sure to see the movie version of this story, starring Mark Wahlberg as Tendinitis, Travis Scott as Ondajon, and Cardi B as Helen.